MODULE 29 · EXAM STRATEGY - ALL DOMAINS

Practice exam 2 – twenty questions

Same 6/4/4/4/2 weighting, twenty fresh questions, and a slightly harder set.

DOMAIN All five WEIGHT 100% MODULE 29 of 31

admin@sthithapragna.com

> An account consumes 300 warehouse credits on Monday and 40 cloud services credits. On Tuesday it consumes 20 warehouse credits and 35 cloud services credits.

On which day is cloud services billed, and why?

A Monday. 40 credits exceeds the flat monthly cloud services allowance.

B Tuesday. The allowance is 10% of that day's warehouse credits, so 2 credits are free and 33 are billed.

C Neither. Cloud services is never billed separately.

D Both. Cloud services is always billed in full.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

On which day is cloud services billed, and why?

A Monday, a flat monthly allowance.

The allowance is daily and proportional, not flat or monthly. Monday's 10% of 300 is 30, and 40 exceeds it by 10.

B Tuesday. 10% of 20 is 2, so 33 are billed.

The allowance is 10% of that day's warehouse credits, calculated daily in UTC. A low-warehouse, high-metadata day is the expensive one.

C Never billed separately.

It is billed above the allowance, which is why the allowance exists.

D Always billed in full.

Ignores the allowance entirely. Most accounts never pay for cloud services.

ON THE EXAM

Module 1. Monday also exceeds its allowance by 10, so the honest answer is 'both, but Tuesday far more'. B states the mechanism correctly.

> A firm on Virtual Private Snowflake wants to publish a free public data product so any Snowflake customer can discover and consume it.

Can they, and why?

A Yes. VPS includes every Business Critical feature plus dedicated infrastructure.

B Yes, but only as a private listing to named accounts.

C No. Public listings require Enterprise Edition specifically.

D No. VPS accounts cannot use the Marketplace or publish public listings.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Can they, and why?

A VPS includes everything Business Critical has.

The common misconception. VPS is not a strict superset: it gains isolation and loses Marketplace access.

B Private listings only.

Close, and the question asks about a public product discoverable by any customer, which VPS cannot do.

C Public listings need Enterprise.

Sharing and listings are Standard Edition features. Edition is not the barrier for anyone else.

D VPS cannot use the Marketplace or public listings.

Documented. Isolation is the point of VPS, and public distribution is what it gives up.

ON THE EXAM

Module 2. The edition ladder is cumulative everywhere except here. VPS trades reach for isolation.

> SYSTEM$CLUSTERING_INFORMATION on a large table returns an average clustering depth of 1.0 for the defined clustering key.

What does that indicate?

A The table is optimally clustered on that key. Depth 1 means partitions do not overlap.

B Clustering has failed. Depth should be as high as possible.

C The table is empty. Only empty tables return 1.0.

D The clustering key uses too many columns and should be reduced.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What does that indicate?

A Optimally clustered. Partitions do not overlap.

Depth starts at 1 and smaller is better. A depth of 1 means no overlapping micro-partitions for that key.

B Depth should be high.

Inverted. A large depth means many overlapping partitions, so a query must scan more of them.

C The table is empty.

An empty table returns 0, not 1. The scenario also says the table is large.

D Too many columns in the key.

Depth measures overlap, not key width. Three or four columns is the guidance, and depth does not report it.

THE SIGNAL

Module 3. Depth is 0 for an empty table, 1 at best, and larger is worse. Two of the distractors invert that scale.

> A dynamic table has been running for six months. A team needs to add a column to its defining SELECT and runs ALTER DYNAMIC TABLE to change the query. The statement fails.

Why, and what is required?

A. The target lag must be set to DOWNSTREAM before the query can be altered.

B. Dynamic tables must be suspended before any ALTER statement.

C. A dynamic table's query is immutable. It must be dropped and recreated.

D. Only the owner may alter it, and the team is using a different role.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Why, and what is required?

A Set TARGET_LAG to DOWNSTREAM first.

DOWNSTREAM ties refresh to consumers. It has nothing to do with changing the query.

B Suspend before altering.

Invented. Suspension does not unlock the query definition.

C The query is immutable. Drop and recreate.

Documented. Other properties such as target lag can be altered; the defining query cannot.

D Only the owner may alter it.

Ownership governs who may alter, not whether the query is alterable at all.

THE SIGNAL

Module 4. Target lag and warehouse can be altered. The query cannot. That asymmetry is what the question tests.

> A team wants Snowflake to execute SQL files held in a private GitHub repository. They have created a secret holding a personal access token.

What else is required, in order?

A A storage integration, then an external stage pointing at the repository.

B An API integration referencing the secret, then a GIT REPOSITORY object.

C A notification integration, then a task that polls the repository.

D Nothing further. A secret alone allows EXECUTE IMMEDIATE FROM a repository URL.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What else is required, in order?

A Storage integration and external stage.

Storage integrations address cloud object storage. A Git repository is reached over HTTPS.

B API integration, then GIT REPOSITORY.

The documented chain: secret, then an API integration with API_PROVIDER = git_https_api, then the repository object.

C Notification integration and a polling task.

Notification integrations carry cloud messaging events. Nothing here involves messaging.

D The secret is enough.

A secret holds credentials. Something must still define the connection to the endpoint.

THE SIGNAL

Modules 5 and 16. A Git repository behaves as a special kind of stage once created. Getting there takes three objects.

> Business users ask questions of a sales database in plain English using Cortex Analyst. The generated SQL runs, but answers are often subtly wrong: 'active customer' is interpreted inconsistently and revenue excludes refunds.

What is the most likely cause?

A Cortex Analyst is trained on general data and cannot learn business definitions.

B Cortex Search should be used instead, since it understands context better.

C The analysts lack privileges on some tables, so partial data is returned.

D The semantic model is too thin. It must describe business concepts and metric handling, not just the schema.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What is the most likely cause?

A It cannot learn business definitions.

That is precisely what the semantic model supplies. The capability exists and was underused.

B Use Cortex Search.

Search is unstructured retrieval. Pointing a structured question at it gives an answer that is valid and useless.

C Missing privileges.

Would produce access errors or missing rows, not a wrong interpretation of 'active customer'.

D **The semantic model is too thin.**

A schema cannot express what the business means by active customer, or how refunds affect revenue. That is the semantic model's job.

THE SIGNAL

Module 6. The risk with Analyst is not security, it is quality. SQL that runs cleanly and answers the wrong question.

A future grant of SELECT on future tables exists at the database level for role REPORTING. A different future grant of SELECT on future tables is then created at the schema level for role AUDIT, in one schema of that database. A new table is created in that schema.

Who can select from it?

A Both roles. Future grants at different levels are additive.

B Neither. Conflicting future grants cancel each other.

C AUDIT only. Schema-level future grants take precedence and the database-level grant is ignored.

D REPORTING only. Database-level grants always outrank schema-level ones.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Who can select from it?

A Both. Additive.

The intuitive answer and not how it works. Precedence selects one level; the other is not applied.

B Neither. They cancel.

Invented. Precedence resolves the conflict rather than voiding both.

C AUDIT only. Schema level wins.

Documented: schema-level future grants take precedence, and the database-level grants are then ignored.

D REPORTING only. Database outranks schema.

Inverted. The more specific level wins, as with network policies.

THE SIGNAL

Module 8. The same 'most specific wins' principle as network policy precedence, applied to a different object.

> A bank on Business Critical has Tri-Secret Secure enabled. An auditor asks what happens to query results if the customer-managed key is revoked in the cloud provider's KMS.

What is the correct answer?

A Snowflake can no longer decrypt the data, and it becomes unreadable including to Snowflake.

B Snowflake falls back to its own key, so queries continue uninterrupted.

C Existing data stays readable; only newly written data is affected.

D Snowflake Support can restore access from Fail-safe within 7 days.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What is the correct answer?

A Unreadable, including to Snowflake.

The composite master key needs both halves. Revoke yours and the composite cannot be formed. That is the feature, and the risk.

B Falls back to Snowflake's key.

Would defeat the entire purpose. If Snowflake could proceed alone, the customer key would guarantee nothing.

C Only new data affected.

The composite key wraps table master keys for existing data too. Everything becomes undecryptable.

D Fail-safe restores access.

Fail-safe recovers dropped data. It cannot decrypt data whose key half has been revoked.

THE SIGNAL

Module 9. This is the intended behaviour, not a failure mode. It is why the documentation warns so heavily about safeguarding the key.

> Classification has tagged a postcode column. The privacy category assigned is QUASI_IDENTIFIER rather than IDENTIFIER.

What does that distinction mean?

A The column was only partially scanned, so the classification is provisional.

B Quasi-identifiers are not considered sensitive and need no masking.

C The semantic category could not be determined, so a fallback was used.

D A postcode does not identify a person alone, but may do so combined with other attributes.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What does that distinction mean?

A Provisional because partially scanned.

Classification does sample up to 10,000 rows, and that affects whether a column is found, not which category it gets.

B Not sensitive, no masking needed.

Quasi-identifiers are a re-identification risk in combination. That is the whole reason the category exists.

C A fallback for unknown semantic category.

The two categories are independent. Privacy category is not a fallback for semantic category.

D Not identifying alone, identifying in combination.

The documented meaning. Postcode plus date of birth plus sex is the classic re-identification example.

THE SIGNAL

Module 10. Every classified column gets both a semantic category, what it is, and a privacy category, how dangerous it is.

> A FinOps team builds a dashboard on SNOWFLAKE.ACCOUNT_USAGE.WAREHOUSE_METERING_HISTORY and wants it to show credit consumption for the current hour so they can react to spikes.

What is wrong with the design?

A WAREHOUSE_METERING_HISTORY does not include credits, only query counts.

B ACCOUNT_USAGE latency of 45 minutes to 3 hours makes current-hour reporting impossible.

C The view requires ORGADMIN, which FinOps will not be granted.

D Nothing is wrong. ACCOUNT_USAGE is the authoritative real-time source.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What is wrong with the design?

A It has no credits, only query counts.

It reports credits consumed per warehouse per hour. That is its purpose.

B Latency makes current-hour reporting impossible.

ACCOUNT_USAGE views lag 45 minutes to 3 hours. The current hour is never fully present.

C Requires ORGADMIN.

ACCOUNT_USAGE is ACCOUNTADMIN by default and can be granted onward. ORGADMIN is for organization-level tasks.

D It is the real-time source.

It is authoritative and not real-time. Those are different properties, and this pair exists because you cannot have both.

THE SIGNAL

Module 11. Same pair as exam 1, asked from the cost side. Authoritative and current are different properties.

> A nightly COPY loads a single 90 GB compressed file from a stage on a 3X-Large warehouse. It takes six hours. Query Profile shows no spilling and the warehouse largely idle.

What should change?

A Split the file into roughly 100 to 250 MB compressed files so loads can run in parallel.

B Resize to 4X-Large so more threads are available.

C Enable the Query Acceleration Service on the loading warehouse.

D Switch the file format from CSV to Parquet, which loads in parallel automatically.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should change?

A Split into 100 to 250 MB files.

Parallel load operations cannot exceed the number of files. One file means one thread, whatever the warehouse size.

B Resize to 4X-Large.

More threads with nothing to do. The warehouse is already largely idle at 3X-Large.

C Query acceleration.

Accelerates scan and filter work on eligible queries. It does not parallelise a single-file load.

D Switch to Parquet.

Format does not create parallelism. One Parquet file is still one file.

THE SIGNAL

Module 13. 'Warehouse largely idle' is the tell. Idle threads mean there is no work to distribute, not that the warehouse is small.

> A partner adds a new column to the middle of their nightly CSV export without notice. The COPY continues to succeed for three weeks before anyone notices that values are landing in the wrong columns.

What prevents this?

A ON_ERROR = ABORT_STATEMENT, so the load fails loudly.

B VALIDATION_MODE on every load, to check files before loading.

C MATCH_BY_COLUMN_NAME, which maps staged columns to target columns by name.

D ENABLE_SCHEMA_EVOLUTION, which adds the new column to the target table.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What prevents this?

A ABORT_STATEMENT.

Aborts on error, and no error occurred. The shifted values were type-compatible, which is why it succeeded.

B VALIDATION_MODE every load.

Loads no data at all, so the table would never be populated. It also would not flag type-compatible shifts.

C MATCH_BY_COLUMN_NAME.

Maps by name rather than position, so an inserted column cannot shift everything after it.

D ENABLE_SCHEMA_EVOLUTION.

Genuinely useful alongside, and on its own it does not fix positional mapping of the existing columns.

THE SIGNAL

Module 14. This is the failure that raises no error at all, which is why it ran for three weeks.

> A team loads files with both a bulk COPY into TABLE_A and a Snowpipe into TABLE_B, from the same stage. They ask how long Snowflake will remember which files have been loaded, in each case.

What are the retention periods?

A 64 days for both, since load metadata is a table property.

B 64 days for the COPY on the table, and 14 days for the pipe on the PIPE object.

C 14 days for both, since Snowpipe governs all load history.

D 7 days for both, matching the ALTER PIPE REFRESH window.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What are the retention periods?

A 64 days for both.

Snowpipe does not use the table's load metadata. Its history lives on the pipe.

B 64 on the table, 14 on the pipe.

Correct on both counts, including where each lives. That location is why recreating a pipe wipes its history.

C 14 for both.

Bulk COPY load metadata is 64 days on the target table.

D 7 days for both.

7 days is the ALTER PIPE REFRESH window, a third number in this area and unrelated to load metadata.

THE SIGNAL

Modules 14 and 15. Three numbers live here: 64 days on the table, 14 on the pipe, 7 for REFRESH. Keep them apart.

> A stream sits on a table with DATA_RETENTION_TIME_IN_DAYS set to 1. The consuming task has been suspended for nine days. An engineer wants to know whether the change records are still available.

What is the position?

A Gone. Retention is 1 day, so the stream went stale on day two.

B Gone, but recoverable from Fail-safe via Snowflake Support.

C Available. Retention was extended automatically to 90 days because the account is on Enterprise.

D Probably available. Retention is extended for an unconsumed stream up to MAX_DATA_EXTENSION_TIME_IN_DAYS, 14 by default. Check STALE_AFTER.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What is the position?

A Gone on day two.

Reasons from the retention setting alone, which is exactly what the extension exists to prevent.

B Recoverable from Fail-safe.

Fail-safe recovers dropped permanent objects. It has no relationship to stream offsets.

C Extended to 90 days on Enterprise.

The extension is bounded by MAX_DATA_EXTENSION_TIME_IN_DAYS, default 14, regardless of edition. 90 days is Time Travel's maximum.

D Probably available. Check STALE_AFTER.

Retention under 14 days is temporarily extended to the stream's offset. Nine days is inside the default bound.

THE SIGNAL

Module 15. Staleness is data loss, so the extension matters. Check STALE_AFTER rather than inferring from the retention setting.

> A monthly board query has returned instantly at no compute cost every month for a year, because the team runs it twice each month-end. This month the finance lead runs it alone, six weeks after the previous run.

What happens, and why?

A It returns instantly. The result cache holds results for a year.

B It fails, because the cached result was purged and the query must be recreated.

C It runs and consumes credits. 24 hours from last use, capped at 31 days from first execution.

D It returns instantly, because monthly queries are exempt from cache expiry.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What happens, and why?

A Cached for a year.

A year is ACCOUNT_USAGE retention, not the result cache. Two different numbers from two different features.

B It fails.

An expired result never causes a failure. The query simply runs and regenerates it.

C Runs and bills. 24 hours from last use, 31 days maximum.

Six weeks exceeds both limits. The twice-a-month habit was keeping the 24-hour window alive.

D Monthly queries are exempt.

Invented. There is no exemption based on frequency.

THE SIGNAL

Module 18. The scenario explains the previous year's behaviour: two runs within 24 hours meant the second was free.

> Search optimization is enabled on a large events table with ALTER TABLE events ADD SEARCH OPTIMIZATION. Point lookups on the id column improve. Queries filtering payload:device_id, a path inside a VARIANT column, do not.

Why?

A Table-level enablement does not cover semi-structured columns. VARIANT needs an explicit ON EQUALITY clause.

B Search optimization does not support VARIANT columns. Flatten the payload first.

C The search access path is still building for VARIANT columns, which are processed last.

D VARIANT paths must be cast before search optimization applies.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Why?

A Table-level skips semi-structured. Use ON EQUALITY.

Documented explicitly. VARIANT, OBJECT and ARRAY are not optimised unless named in an ON clause.

B VARIANT is unsupported.

Well supported: equality, IN, ARRAY_CONTAINS, ARRAYS_OVERLAP, SEARCH, substring and NULL checks. It just needs naming.

C Still building, VARIANT last.

Building does take time, and no documented ordering leaves VARIANT until the end.

D Cast the path first.

Matching a VARIANT element against a constant works without an explicit cast.

THE SIGNAL

Module 20. The other columns improving is the clue. The feature works; it was never switched on for the column that matters.

> A report has slowed from minutes to hours. Query Profile shows a Join node at 88% of execution time, with 1.8 million rows entering one side, 3.2 million the other, and 9.1 billion rows leaving. Remote spilling is heavy.

What should be done first?

A Scale up. The remote spilling is the primary problem.

B Add a clustering key to both source tables to reduce the scan.

C Enable the Query Acceleration Service to offload the join.

D Fix the join condition. The row multiplication indicates a missing or too-loose predicate.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should be done first?

A Scale up for the spilling.

The spilling is a consequence. 9.1 billion rows exhausts any warehouse, and a bigger one produces them faster.

B Cluster both source tables.

Addresses scanning. The inputs are already small; the problem is what the join does with them.

C Query acceleration.

Accelerates scan and filter work, not joins, and it cannot help a query producing rows that should not exist.

D Fix the join condition.

Rows out exceed rows in roughly two-thousandfold. That is the documented exploding-join signature.

THE SIGNAL

Module 19. The spilling is real and downstream. Fixing the cause removes it; scaling up merely pays more for the same mistake.

A stored procedure must set a session parameter for the caller and then read from a table the caller can access. It is created with EXECUTE AS OWNER and fails when it attempts to set the parameter.

Why?

A Session parameters can only be set by ACCOUNTADMIN, whatever the rights model.

B Owner's rights procedures are not permitted to change session state. Use caller's rights.

C The procedure must be created with a RETURNS clause before it can set parameters.

D Owner's rights is not the default, so the procedure was misconfigured.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Why?

A Only ACCOUNTADMIN can set them.

Session parameters are routinely set by ordinary roles. The rights model is the constraint here.

B Owner's rights cannot change session state. Use caller's rights.

Documented. Caller's rights procedures can view, set and unset session variables, and those changes persist after the CALL.

C A RETURNS clause is needed first.

Every CREATE PROCEDURE needs a RETURNS clause anyway, so the procedure would not have been created without one.

D Owner's rights is not the default.

It is the default. The scenario also states it was chosen explicitly.

THE SIGNAL

Module 22. Owner's rights buys delegated privilege and gives up session control. Caller's rights is the reverse trade.

> A production database containing tasks and clustered tables is cloned to create a staging environment. A week later the staging team reports that nothing has refreshed and clustering has not been maintained.

What is the explanation?

A Cloned tasks are created suspended, and Automatic Clustering starts suspended on the clone.

B Clones are read-only until ownership is transferred from the cloning role.

C Clones share micro-partitions with the source, so they cannot be reclustered independently.

D The clone inherited no grants, so the tasks lack privileges to run.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What is the explanation?

A Tasks and clustering both start suspended.

Documented for both. The clustering key is replicated; the maintenance is not resumed.

B Read-only until ownership transfers.

Invented. A clone is fully independent and writable from creation.

C Cannot be reclustered independently.

Sharing partitions is how cloning works, and the clone diverges freely as either object changes.

D No grants, so tasks cannot run.

Cloning a database does propagate child object grants. And a suspended task would not run even with every privilege.

THE SIGNAL

Module 23. Two separate defaults, one symptom each, and both are on the list of things a clone does not inherit.

> A provider shares data with a partner through a reader account. The partner runs increasingly heavy queries. The provider wants to limit the spend without removing access.

What should they do?

A. Ask Snowflake to bill the partner directly for reader account compute.

B. Convert the reader account to a full consumer account, which shifts the cost.

C. Apply a resource monitor to the reader account's warehouse, with a quota and a suspend trigger.

D. Nothing. Reader account compute is uncapped by design.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should they do?

A Have Snowflake bill the partner.

The provider creates, owns and pays for a reader account. There is no billing relationship with the partner.

B Convert to a full consumer account.

Not a conversion. The partner would need their own Snowflake account, which is why a reader account was chosen.

C A resource monitor on the reader account.

The provider owns the account, so they can cap its warehouse with a quota and suspend trigger. Access remains.

D Uncapped by design.

The provider owns the account and has the usual controls, including resource monitors.

THE SIGNAL

Modules 11 and 24. The provider pays, and because they own the account they also hold every cost control it has.

Answer key and domain map

Q	ANSWER	DOMAIN AND TOPIC
1-3	B, D, A	D1: cloud services allowance, VPS and Marketplace, clustering depth
4-6	C, B, D	D1: dynamic table immutability, Git chain, semantic model
7-10	C, A, D, B	D2: future grant precedence, Tri-Secret Secure, privacy category, ACCOUNT_USAGE latency
11-14	A, C, B, D	D3: file count and parallelism, MATCH_BY_COLUMN_NAME, 64 vs 14 days, stream extension
15-18	C, A, D, B	D4: 31-day cache ceiling, SOS on VARIANT, exploding join, owner's rights
19-20	A, C	D5: what a clone does not inherit, reader account cost control

ON THE EXAM

Five of each letter again, and no two adjacent questions share an answer. Compare your domain pattern with exam 1.

Comparing the two exams

- **A lower score here than on exam 1 is expected.** This set leans on details rather than headline facts.
- **Compare the domain pattern, not the totals.** A domain that let you down twice is the one to revisit.
- **Questions 1, 7, 13 and 15 all turn on a number.** If those caught you, the numbers are worth a dedicated pass.
- **Questions 11, 12, 17 and 19 are 'nothing is broken' or defaults.** That shape recurs more than any other.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> Next: practice exam 3, the hardest of the three, then module 00 to open the course.